

Men & Makeover

Urban Indian males are spending more on personal grooming

■ Indian men spend 20 minutes in front of the window on an average, compared to 18 minutes spent by women.

■ Over 70 per cent of India's urban males visit a salon once a month for hairstyling, facials and skin-lifting treatments.

■ One in three men claims he visits a hair salon two to three times a month.

■ Three in five single men claim they try to look stylish at all times.

■ The market worth of personal grooming industry is Rs 6,950 crore, growing at a rate of 11 per cent.

■ Eleven per cent men indulge in facial treatments.

■ Men's spending on grooming is up by 20 per cent.

■ In 2000, they spent less than Rs 1,000 per month in 2000 on personal products. It's Rs 2,500 in over 50 per cent Indian households now.

■ Male consumers tend to spend more on cosmetics (Rs 300-500 more per month than women).

■ The target profile of most personal care product companies is the urban male between 25 and 45 years of age.

■ Spending on men's grooming products is slated to rise by 24 per cent in the next five years.

■ Men's fairness cream market is one of the biggest in the world, growing at 10 per cent.

(Source: AC Nielsen survey on male grooming conducted amongst 1,000 Sec A and B men in four cities of Mumbai, Delhi, Kolkata and Hyderabad in September 2007).

AFTER



RAHUL BHATT SIX-PACK ABS

He knows Bollywood's bodily norms inside out: as a fitness pro in Mumbai, he coaches a swarm of Bollywood aspirants. As veteran filmmaker, Mahesh Bhatt's son, he is privy to the pulls and pressures of the tinsel town. "This is a world of harsh judgments, where appearance counts for all." He routinely comes across people who ruin their health trying to acquire chiselled looks—either on anabolic steroids or cosmetic procedures. His love for bodybuilding has helped him change from an overweight teenager to a man with a stomach of steel.

BEFORE



needed to bare his torso. "Initially I felt I would lose the offer because of my belly bulge," he says. "Finally a friend advised me to go in for an abminoplasty."

What do men want? Unlike their female counterparts, the male clients are more clear about the new image they want, say medics. Enlarged breasts (gynecomastia) is a big issue for Indian men, and across all age groups. In PGIMER, 50 per cent male patients come for this. Another set of younger males need 'body contouring' surgery for loose skinfolds, left as a result of excessive gymming or dieting. Nearly 60 per cent of men between age 35 and 45 ask for this at Gangaram. Others opt for liposuction to get rid of excess and stubborn fat in lower abdomen. Men also going for tightening of abdominal muscles for a stronger tummy. Making the chin more prominent and, thus, giving the face a more chiselled look is

yet another demand for the 35-plus brigade. Removing frown lines, wrinkles around the eyes and lifting a sagging face are age-related problems, with patients in the 45-plus age bracket. "Most men want to get a sharper look," says Kolkata-based aesthetic surgeon Dr Manoj Khanna. And they are ready to go in for minor procedures to remove the slightest of defects. "They would want to do away with a mark or a mole even if those don't look abnormal." Says Venkatesh: "Eyelid surgery and facial rejuvenation are the other procedures commonly asked for by young men, professionals, students and aspiring models."

Even traditional workouts have changed to meet the new demand. "India's strongest man" Manoj Chopra trains at Steves Gym in Bangalore, one of the city's premier fitness centres founded by Stephen S.D. Earlier, most males would do the regular treadmill-